FIDELIS : Brand Governance Platform

Round 1: The Plan | Problem statement by Inkloom AI | Team: Hackex | Members: Alfred Biju,Adhithyan Biju , Albert Biju

1. Defining the problem and providing the evidence

Today, organisations release content using their employees, agencies, and AI tools. Each of them understands the brand guidelines in a different way, and the guidelines are typically a static PDF which no one is able to check draft versions against as a result of which incorrect claims, out-of-date facts, an inconsistent tone and visuals that are not in keeping with the brand reach the public before anyone realises.

Evidence (published industry surveys, mostly self-reported):

Around 85 per cent of organisations do have brand guidelines but only about 30 per cent enforce them consistently (Marq research, via Emulent).

Eighty-one per cent of the organisations which were surveyed come across unbranded content, and 71 per cent state that the greatest cost of such content is confusion in the market (Lucidpress/Demand Metric survey).

There is a legal risk involved in making unbacked promotional claims since the US Federal Trade Commission mandates that such claims must be based on a reasonable basis and in 2023 issued penalty notices to around 670 companies. In India, the ASCI deals with complaints concerning false or unsubstantiated advertisements.

2. Target Users and Organisational Setting

This section describes who will use the system and the environment in which it will operate. Target users include both technical and non-technical staff. They may work in different departments, such as IT, finance, or HR. The organisation may have a central office, branch offices, or remote workers. The system must fit into this structure and support different user needs. Understanding the users and their setting helps shape the design and features of the system.

Setting: a company or agency that is expanding (with between 50 and 500 employees) and which produces marketing, social, sales, and product content via a number of teams, independent contractors, and AI tools, the brand team being responsible for the guidelines.

Content creators want their messages to be given quick and clear feedback and to have any necessary corrections made.

Brand managers want the guidelines to be enforced on a large scale and also to find out which mistakes keep happening.

Legal reviewers, compliance officers and experts want to see only those issues which require judgement, together with evidence.

People who approve things and those who have administrative responsibilities would like to have an audit trail and the protection of confidential material.

3. Research and Supporting Evidence

The secondary evidence is given in Section 1; the research that we carried out prior to the build window:

5 to 8 brief interviews were conducted with individuals who create or approve content (such as members of club social teams and freelancers, as well as small business owners). Result: [include the findings and two quotations].

A short survey (with 20 or more responses) asked the following questions: Do you have written guidelines? How do you check the content? Have you made any corrections after publishing? Do you use AI tools? The results are as follows: [add percentages].

I checked one real public brand guideline against 10 of its public posts. I logged rule violations and unclear rules. Result: [add counts].

4. The suggested solution, the value proposition and the workflow

Solution: CANON converts the brand guidelines into a set of testable rules and checks the content against these rules before it is published. It provides an explanation for each finding, references the specific rule or approved fact that underlies it, and proposes remedies that preserve the creator's original purpose. Nevertheless, humans are responsible for making the final decisions.

What makes it different:

When checking claims with regard to their expiry date, each claim in the content is linked to an approved fact which has an owner and an expiry date, thus ensuring that obsolete facts are identified.

There is no citation and no flag; whenever an AI-generated finding fails to point to an actual rule or source, the verification step rejects it, thus ensuring that the results are both explainable and reliable.

For Intent Lock, the suggested edits are small and have been verified to ensure that the original purpose, audience, and key facts are maintained.

The governance insights indicate that where overrides are repeated and errors occur, it is clear that certain guidelines are unclear and suggest improvements.

The advantages include fewer off-brand or unsupported publications, quicker reviews, and a clear record showing who approved each item.

Workflow:

The brand manager uploads the guidelines, the approved facts, the terminology and the assets; CANON then turns these into rules, after which the manager confirms them.

The creator sends the text, the document, or the image.

CANON carries out exact checks (covering terminology, colours, contrast, and alt text) as well as AI checks (related to tone, messaging, and claims).

Each finding is checked to see that it conforms with the relevant rule or fact.

The creator notices the problem, identifies the cause and origin and receives a proposed solution, after which he accepts it, makes edits to it or challenges it.

The manager and the reviewers either comment or give their approval, or approve with a written exception; all revisions are saved.

A record of the reviews is stored and the dashboard displays the recurring problems and unclear rules.

5. Features, the technology stack, integrations and data sources

The features include importing guidelines and facts, reviewing text and files in DOCX and PDF format as well as images, checking tone, terminology, claims, visuals, and accessibility, providing explanations of the findings together with citations, suggesting corrections, including comments, handling approvals, maintaining a revision history, and offering role-based access to the insights dashboard.

The stack includes a frontend built with Next.js, a backend developed using FastAPI (in Python), PostgreSQL together with pgvector, a hosted API for the large language model used for language-related tasks, a local embedding model, Tesseract OCR, OpenCV as well as colour libraries for visual verification, and python-docx and pdfplumber for handling documents.

Integrations: the LLM API will be included as part of the build; Google Docs and Slack/Teams notifications are on the roadmap.

The data comes from user-supplied guidelines and fact sheets; for the demonstration we have used a fictitious brand together with a synthetic guideline and around 40 labelled examples of posts, thus no actual confidential data has been used.

6. Responsible Design

With regard to privacy, the confidential terms are hidden before any call is made to an external AI; each vault may be configured to use hosted AI, to have only the terms masked, or to operate solely locally; content is not used for training models.

Security features include role-based access control, encrypted storage, limits on uploads, treatment of uploaded content as data rather than as instructions in order to prevent prompt injection, and an audit log of all actions.

There will be human oversight since the AI never publishes, approves or edits by itself and any suggestion can be rejected or objected to; exceptions must be reviewed and a written reason given.

This should be made clear in each review by indicating the AI models and external services that were used, and by marking AI suggestions.

7. Plan for development, the roles involved and the expected impact

Phase 1: setup. Login and roles. Database. Sample brand data.

Phase 2: core workflow — rule import, fact vault, review of texts and documents, findings, and approvals.

In phase 3 the improvements were citation verification, Intent Lock and the insights dashboard.

In phase 4, the images are checked, tested, and any bugs are fixed together with the preparation of the README and the demo.

The roles are: [AI and rules: name] | [Backend and security: name] | [Frontend and UX: name] | [Research, docs and demo: name]. Libraries will be reused and AI assistance will be made public, with no code being written before the official build window opens.

The expected impact (measured on our test set) is that we should detect at least 80% of the issues that have been planted, most of the findings which are blocking in nature should come with a verified citation, the time taken for reviews should be reduced, each claim must be

traceable to an approved and up-to-date source, and the guidelines should become clearer over time.